

Broken-Link Checker

Feature 11 of 13 — catches dead affiliate links automatically, once a week, for free.

- No setup required
- Free weekly GitHub Action
- Runs manually any time

1 What this does

A script checks every URL in `data/products.json` and `data/brokers.json` — 173 links today — and reports any that are dead (404, timeout, DNS failure, etc.). It's already scheduled to run automatically every Monday via GitHub Actions, completely free.

2 Nothing to configure

This is live the moment the repo is pushed to GitHub — no secrets, no environment variables. You'll see it listed in your repo's **Actions** tab as "Weekly broken link check."

3 Run it manually any time

FROM YOUR COMPUTER

Command line

`node scripts/check-links.mjs`

FROM GITHUB

Actions tab

Go to Actions → "Weekly broken link check" → Run workflow

WHEN IT FAILS

What you'll see

A red ✕ in the Actions tab and a list of exactly which tools/URLs are broken in the run's log

4 Fixing what it finds

Open `data/products.json` or `data/brokers.json`, find the flagged entry by name, and either fix the URL or remove the entry if the tool has shut down.

5 Where the code lives

File	Purpose
<code>scripts/check-links.mjs</code>	The checker itself
<code>.github/workflows/check-links.yml</code>	The free weekly scheduler

False positives

Some sites block automated HEAD/GET requests entirely (bot protection) even though the page works fine for a real visitor. If a flagged link opens fine in your browser, it's a false positive — no action needed.